Conor McKeon

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English – native language French – fluent German – beginner

I am an Irish researcher and recent M.Sc graduate, passionate about innovation in the field of cellular and genetic medicine. As a creative thinker and motivated problem solver, I am eager to apply my skills and experience to the development of advanced therapeutics. My studies encompassing biochemistry, molecular biology, cell biology and genetics put me in an excellent position to advance research and development projects for cell and gene therapies.

PROFICIENCIES

- **Molecular biology techniques**: Plasmid editing, RNA/ DNA extraction, transfection, nucleic acid electrophoresis, PCR and RT-qPCR.
- **Biochemistry techniques**: Protein HPLC and affinity purification, SDS-PAGE, Western Blot, protein-based assays, Chromatin Immunoprecipitation.
- **Instrumentation:** AKTA Pure HPLC, Mx3000P qPCR, Native & HDX-MS, NMR
- **Data analysis and graphing:** Excel, GraphPad Prism, R-Studio.
- Analysis of RNA-seq data using command line tools in Linux and R-Studio.
- Aseptic cell-culture, media preparation and performance of cell-based assays.
- Design, production, purification, and analysis of tagged and modified proteins.
- Effective data analysis and compelling written and oral presentation of research results.

EDUCATION

M.Sc. Health-Biology **2020 – 2022**
University of Montpellier **Mention Très Bien (1st Class Honours)**

This two-year degree, taught through French, was aimed at developing the interdisciplinary skills required to meet current needs in the translation of research into actionable therapies and medicines. During these two years I became very interested in genomics and structural and molecular biology. I oriented my modules and internships to pursue a career developing cell and gene therapies.

B.Sc. Chemistry **2015 – 2019**
University College Galway **1st Class Honours**

This four-year programme allowed me to take a variety of subjects in the general scientific field before deciding to specialise in Chemistry for my honours degree.

EXPERIENCE

❑ **Analytice** **April 2022 – Current**

43 Route du Polygone, Strasbourg

- In this role as a Scientific and Technical Advisor, I propose laboratory solutions adapted to the specific needs of the client, for analysis of a wide variety of samples including cosmetics, agri-food and materials.

❑ **Helmlinger Lab** **Jan – July 2022**

Montpellier Research Centre for Cell Biology

- Trainee researcher exploring the roles of co-activator complexes in gene expression regulation.
- My work involved firstly editing and transforming plasmids in yeast, to create a Cre-Lox inducible mutation system at the endogenous gene of a transcription factor. I verified successful gene editing by genomic PCR and Western Blot of affinity-purified protein. I performed RT-qPCR on purified total RNA to analyse the effect of inducing the mutation on the expression of a regulated gene.
- My collaboration on this project earned me a place as a co-author on a forthcoming publication in *Nature Structural and Molecular Biology*.

• Gene Editing • PCR • Protein purification • Western Blot • RNA/DNA Extraction • RT-qPCR

❑ **Granier-Mouillac Lab** **Jan – July 2021**

Institute of Functional Genomics, Montpellier

- Trainee researcher applying native mass spectrometry to study the key structural and mechanistic elements of the interactions between G-protein coupled receptors and bacterial leukotoxins.
- I produced membrane-bound GPCRs in SF9 cells, which I purified and used alongside purified bacterial leukotoxins in Native and HDX-MS analyses to identify binding stoichiometries, protein interaction interfaces, and allosteric binding effects.

• Sf9 Cell Culture • Affinity & AKTA SEC protein purification • Native & HDX-MS

❑ **Pfizer Global Supply** **June – Aug 2019**

Pfizer Headquarters, New York

- Internship Assistant to the director of Operations and Communications, managing concerns from API and vaccine manufacturing sites worldwide.

❑ **Marine Biodiscovery Group** **Jan – May 2019**

University College Galway

- Research intern purifying rare metabolites from marine organisms for molecular analysis, leading to the discovery of a novel bioactive histidine derivative.

• Molecular purification • HPLC • LC-MS/MS • NMR